

Is the use of water by AI a real issue?

Posted by u/DraconicDreamer3072 • 0 points • 109 comments

specifically, I want to find out how much water data centres are using as a comparable figure such as gallons per minute. (and also do they use closed source?)

are data centres water usage actually increased much if at all due to AI? or is AI just using existing infrastructure?

and are data centres actually using a significant amount more water compared to other water hogs like nuclear power, agriculture, etc?

tried googling it, but mostly I just get a bunch of anti AI biased articles full of emotional words and no actual supporting numbers or very vague ones (like the water could support x number of towns)

Comments

u/AI_EdgeAlpha • 1 points • 2026-03-29 22:53 UTC

The smart way to discuss this is not “AI bad” or “AI harmless,” but workload, cooling design, location, and whether the marginal water use is actually being measured honestly.

u/Just-Hedgehog-Days • 1 points • 2026-03-29 22:34 UTC

On the whole, no. It really isn't. Total volume jus isn't a thing on, say, and agrocltural scale.

That said, we're building data centers at a rate the compltely outstrips infrastrucutre, and some areas have been impacted because there just wasn't enough water **there** to do it correctly.

u/evangelism2 • 1 points • 2026-03-29 21:24 UTC

on this sub, no.

but even before AI, clean water was becoming an issue.